

“As I see it, you have some pressing debts that have to be dealt with rather quickly. When you elected to file the Chapter 13 bankruptcy, you made an agreement not to incur any additional debts until the payment period expired. Now you have an additional fifteen hundred dollars in debt that the court doesn’t know about. The first thing you need to do is deal with that situation. I don’t suppose you have any surplus funds that can be used to pay these bills, do you?”

“No, sir,” Ben replied. “Only what’s in the checking account, which isn’t much right now.”

“You’ll need that for normal living expenses,” Bryan said. “Do you have any surplus in your account, Naomi?”

Naomi sat silently for several moments before she spoke. “Yes, I do. But I don’t want to use it to pay for Ben’s indulgences.”

“I can understand that,” Bryan said, “but if you’re going to work out this situation and find a permanent solution, it will be because you do it together, working as one unit. If you’re holding the money as a nest egg in case the marriage doesn’t work out, it won’t.

“Remember,” the coach continued, “Satan would like nothing better than to drive a wedge between you and Ben, and God can only work in your marriage if you make an irrevocable commitment to make it work. God has a role for each of you, and your marriage will work if you follow His principles.”

“But Ben doesn’t behave responsibly in our home,” Naomi protested. “So am I supposed to turn over all the money to him, knowing it will be spent foolishly?”

“No,” Bryan assured her. “The way to balance one extreme is not to go to another. God put you two together because you need the balance that each offers the other. You must work together as one. Now is your chance to decide whether you trust God or just say that you trust God.

“Anyone can help you manage the money and pay the bills. That’s a matter of following a plan I’ll outline for you. But the financial problems you have are really symptoms of greater problems that